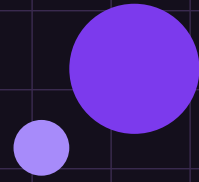


CHAPTER 11



Your 30-Day Roadmap to Your First Product Design Job

A Practical Step-by-Step Plan to Go from Learning to Landing Interviews



FROM BEGINNER TO HIRED

"Knowledge changes nothing until it becomes action."

SARAH'S STORY - FROM LEARNING TO DOING

Follow Sarah's journey as the chapter turns theory into a realistic career-change scenario.

Sarah's Story - From Learning to Doing

Sarah closed the final page of her notebook.

For six months she had watched videos.

Read articles.

Taken courses.

Designed apps.

Built portfolios.

Yet something still felt missing.

She wasn't applying what she knew consistently.

One evening she spoke with her mentor.

"I still don't feel ready."

He smiled.

"You never will."

Sarah laughed.

"Seriously?"

"No designer ever feels completely ready."

"The people who get hired aren't the ones who know everything."

"They're the ones who keep moving."

He handed her a simple sheet of paper.

Thirty small tasks.

One each day.

"Don't try to change your life today."

"Just complete today's task."

Thirty days later Sarah had:
improved her portfolio,
published three case studies,
updated LinkedIn,
completed five mock interviews,
applied for twelve carefully chosen jobs.
Momentum changed everything.

What You'll Learn

By the end of this chapter you'll have:

A practical 30-day roadmap.
Daily tasks that take 30–90 minutes.
Clear milestones.
AI-powered exercises.
Portfolio goals.
Interview preparation.
Job application strategy.

By Day 30, you'll be ready to apply confidently for junior Product Design roles.

Before You Begin

This plan assumes you already have:

- Basic Figma knowledge.
- Three portfolio projects (or one strong project in progress).
- A LinkedIn account.
- A willingness to practise consistently.

You don't need perfection.

You need commitment.

WEEK ONE

Build Strong Foundations

Day 1

Write your career goal.

Example:

"I will become a Junior Product Designer within the next six months."

Create a folder called:

From Beginner to Hired

Everything you create over the next month belongs here.

Day 2

Research ten Product Design job descriptions.

Highlight:

Skills

Tools

Responsibilities

Common requirements

Notice the patterns.

Day 3

Improve your LinkedIn profile.

Update:

Headline

About section

Featured projects

Skills

Ask AI to review your profile.

Day 4

Review your portfolio homepage.

Ask yourself:

Would a recruiter understand what I do within ten seconds?

If not...

Simplify it.

Day 5

Choose your three strongest projects.

Remove weaker work.

Remember:

Quality beats quantity.

Day 6

Rewrite one project using the case study framework from Chapter 7.

Focus on:

Problem.

Research.

Insights.

Outcome.

Reflection.

Day 7

Ask someone else to review your portfolio.

Don't defend your work.

Listen.

Take notes.

Improve.

Week One Reflection

Ask yourself:

What improved?

What still needs work?

Which feedback surprised you?

WEEK TWO

Become Interview Ready

Day 8

Research one company.

Read:

Their mission.

Their product.

Recent news.

User reviews.

Day 9

Practise introducing yourself.

Record yourself.

Aim for two minutes.

Day 10

Present one case study aloud.

Time yourself.

Aim for:

8–10 minutes.

Day 11

Complete an AI mock interview.

Prompt:

"Act as a Senior Product Designer interviewing me for a Junior Product Designer role."

Day 12

Improve your CV.

Tailor it to one job description.

Day 13

Write one personalised cover letter.

No templates.

Write to one company.

Day 14

Review everything.

Portfolio.

CV.

LinkedIn.

Case Studies.

Celebrate your progress.

Week Two Reflection

How confident do you feel?

Score yourself:

Portfolio

□□□□

Interview

□□□□

CV

□□□□

Communication

□□□□

WEEK THREE

Build Professional Confidence

Day 15

Redesign one small interaction.

Don't redesign an entire app.

Focus on one problem.

Day 16

Read one UX case study.

Write three lessons you learned.

Day 17

Learn one accessibility principle.

Apply it immediately.

Day 18

Improve your AI workflow.

Experiment with three new prompts.

Day 19

Write a LinkedIn post about something you've learned.

Build in public.

Day 20

Attend one online design event.

Or watch one conference presentation.

Take notes.

Day 21

Update your portfolio with everything you've improved this month.

Week Three Reflection

You're no longer simply learning.

You're becoming a practising Product Designer.

WEEK FOUR

Start Applying

Day 22

Choose five companies.

Research each one.

Day 23

Tailor your CV.

Day 24

Tailor your portfolio.

Highlight the most relevant project.

Day 25

Submit your first application.

Not ten.

One excellent application.

Day 26

Complete another mock interview.

Focus on storytelling.

Day 27

Apply to two more roles.

Quality over quantity.

Day 28

Request portfolio feedback from another experienced designer.

Day 29

Review your progress.

What improved?

What still feels difficult?

Day 30

Celebrate.

You now have:

☐ **Portfolio**

☐ **Case Studies**

- CV
- LinkedIn

☐ **Interview Practice**

- AI Workflow

☐ **Job Applications**

You're officially job ready.